

London's Greatest Museums



10 World-Class Museums · All Free · Central London

London's world-famous museums are almost all free — but knowing which galleries to head straight to saves hours. This guide takes you to the best rooms in each museum, skipping the crowds.

YOU SAVE: £437+ vs guided tours

■ WHAT THIS GUIDE SAVES YOU

Retail price of this guide
£12.99

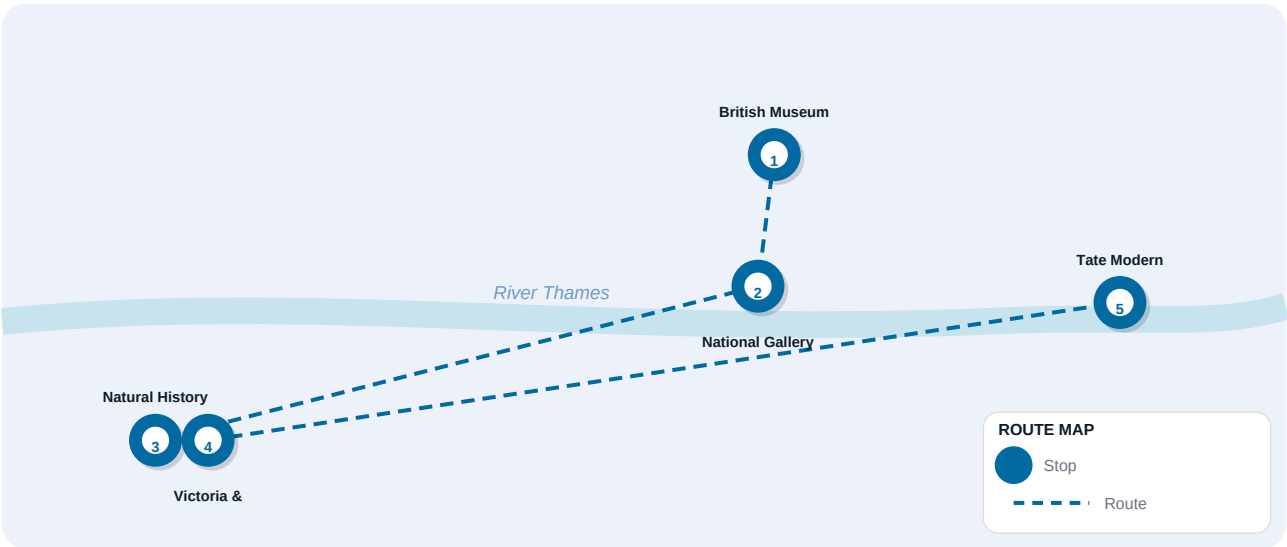
Equivalent guided tours
£450+

YOUR SAVING
£437+

ROUTE INFO

■ Start	British Museum — Room 4 (Rosetta Stone) (Bloomsbury)
■ End	Tate Modern — Turbine Hall + Level 10 (Bankside)
■ Duration	All Free
■ Transport	From central London: Zone 1–2 daily cap £8.10 covers all stops
■ Total Cost	Guide: £12.99 · Most stops FREE · See individual stop costs

SCHEMATIC ROUTE MAP



PRO TIPS — READ BEFORE YOU GO

■ Best day	Tuesday–Thursday for fewer crowds at almost every location
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■ Saving	Pre-book anything with tickets — usually £2–4 discount per person
■ Offline map	Download Google Maps offline before leaving your hotel
■ Transport	Use Contactless card — automatic daily cap (Zone 1: £8.10, Zone 1-2: £10.10)
■ Members only	This guide is exclusive to London Lens lifetime subscribers

■■ COMPLETE STOP GUIDE — LONDON'S GREATEST MUSEUMS

Follow stops 1→5 in order for the best walking route. Each card includes insider tips, savings info, and the cheapest transport option.

1

British Museum — Room 4 (Rosetta Stone)

Bloomsbury · Daily 10am–5pm (Fri to 8:30pm)

■ START HERE

HIDDEN TIP

Skip the main entrance queue — enter from the Montague Place back entrance. Room 4 for the Rosetta Stone is always packed; arrive at 10am opening or after 4pm. The Lewis Chessmen in Room 40 are always quiet.

■ **SAVING**

Equivalent museums in NYC/Paris charge £20–£30 entry. Saving: £25

■ **CHEAPEST TRANSPORT**

Holborn (5 min walk) or Tottenham
Cost: Zone 1 — all included in daily cap £8.10

DO THIS:

- ✓ Room 40: Lewis Chessmen (almost always empty)
- ✓ Room 41: Sutton Hoo Helmet
- ✓ Ask for the free floor plan at information desk
- Best: 10am opening or after 4:30pm

AVOID:

Weekday mornings in summer — school groups

★★★★★

Free

2

National Gallery — The Sunflowers

Trafalgar Square · Daily 10am–6pm (Fri to 9pm)

■ 15 min or tube

HIDDEN TIP

Room 43 has Van Gogh's Sunflowers — arrive early. But the real secret is Room 66: the tiny Rembrandt self-portraits room. Almost never crowded and infinitely more moving than the main galleries.

■ **SAVING**

£25 equivalent at Musée d'Orsay. Saving: £25

■ **CHEAPEST TRANSPORT**

Charing Cross (3 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Room 66: Rembrandt self-portraits (secret gem)
- ✓ Room 34: Turner's Fighting Temeraire
- ✓ Free guided tours daily at 11:30am and 2:30pm
- Best: Friday late opening (open to 9pm) — romantic and quiet

AVOID:

Weekend afternoons in summer

★★★★★

Free

3



Natural History Museum — Spirit C

■ 20 min or tube

South Kensington · Daily 10am–5:50pm

HIDDEN TIP

The famous diplodocus hall (Hintze Hall) is stunning but rammed. Walk straight through to the Darwin Centre — the 22-metre glass Cocoon building houses 17 million preserved specimens. Eerily beautiful and almost always quiet.

■ SAVING

Comparable to NYC Museum of Natural History: £28. Saving: £28

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

South Kensington (5 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Darwin Centre Cocoon — 17 million specimens behind glass
 - ✓ Vault Gallery — the Hope Diamond of London museums
 - ✓ Book a free scientist talk at the info desk
- Best: Tuesday–Thursday mornings

AVOID:

School holidays — dippy the diplodocus gets mobbed

★★★★★

Free

4



Victoria & Albert Museum — Cast C

■ 8 min walk from NHM

South Kensington · Daily 10am–5:45pm (Fri to 10pm)

HIDDEN TIP

The main V&A galleries are extraordinary but the Cast Courts (Rooms 46a & 46b) are sensational and virtually unknown. Full-size plaster casts of Michelangelo's David and Trajan's Column — the only way to see them side by side.

■ SAVING

£20 entry equivalent at comparable European museums. Saving: £20

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

South Kensington (8 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Cast Courts: David AND Trajan's Column for free
 - ✓ Room 41: the medieval treasury
 - ✓ The Garden Café courtyard for a rest
- Best: Midday on a weekday

AVOID:

The gift shop

★★★★★

Free



Tate Modern — Turbine Hall + Level 10

■ 25 min or tube

Bankside · Sun–Thu 10am–6pm, Fri–Sat 10am–10pm

HIDDEN TIP

Level 10 is the best FREE view of St Paul's in London. Take the Blavatnik Building lift — most visitors don't know it exists. The permanent Turbine Hall commission is always staggering and always free.

■ SAVING

The View from The Shard charges £33.
Saving: £33

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Blackfriars (5 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Level 10 viewing platform — free and extraordinary
- ✓ Current Turbine Hall commission (always spectacular)
- ✓ Walk the Millennium Bridge for the classic view
- Best: Late afternoon for the St Paul's golden hour view

AVOID:

Weekend afternoons

★★★★★

Free

QUICK REFERENCE CARD — CUT OUT OR SCREENSHOT

Summary of all stops for easy on-the-go reference.

#	Name	Area	Walk	Cost	Tube	Rating
1	British Museum — Room ...	Bloomsbury	Start here	Free	Holborn (5 min wal	★★★★★
2	National Gallery — The...	Trafalgar Square	15 min or tube	Free	Charing Cross (3 m	★★★★★
3	Natural History Museum...	South Kensington	20 min or tube	Free	South Kensington (	★★★★★
4	Victoria & Albert Muse...	South Kensington	8 min walk fro	Free	South Kensington (	★★★★★
5	Tate Modern — Turbine ...	Bankside	25 min or tube	Free	Blackfriars (5 min	★★★★★

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